

House hacking is the most powerful tool in your arsenal if you want to achieve FI in a short period, particularly for those with lower incomes and those with student loan debt who would otherwise have difficulty saving. When done well, it eliminates the largest item in most people's budgets, adds a small amount of income, and it's an investment. You can build wealth by spending less, earning more, or investing better. The decision to hack your housing allows you to pull all three levers simultaneously.

There are other options if you do not want to share your living space in the long-term. Do you have space that you could use as an Airbnb rental? Could you rent storage space in your garage, basement, or attic? Could you rent an unused parking spot? Once you understand the importance and impact of flipping the housing equation, you are limited only by your imagination to achieve FI sooner.

Some people may not want to pursue a house hack even after seeing the numbers. There are more options to optimize housing costs shared by others in the FI community.

*Physician on FIRE* reports he came out of residency in a position common to many new physicians. He could command a high income but was saddled with debt accrued during his training.